

Scott Penberthy

Said **Pen-ber-thee****300+** keynotes given**2016** started Google Cloud's first applied AI team**25 years** chasing one problem

The bio

340 WORDS

For a programme, a website, or a conference listing. This is the default.

Scott Penberthy went to MIT at sixteen and finished a PhD in computer science and artificial intelligence at the University of Washington. In the early nineties he was technical assistant to Lou Gerstner at IBM. He saw the web coming in 1992 and built IBM's first web browser and first web server. It started with four people. It grew to two hundred, and became IBM's hosting and middleware businesses, earning four billion and thirteen billion dollars a year by the time he left.

He ran engineering at Photobucket next. Fifty million people kept their photos there and a hundred thousand more arrived every day, on machines the team built and ran themselves. He was there when it sold for three hundred million. Then he moved PwC to the cloud across a hundred and sixty countries, the first deal of its kind in financial services.

He joined Google Cloud in 2016, when it was doing less than half a billion dollars a year, and started its first applied AI team. He aimed it at science and regulated industries, because those were the hardest and the barriers were highest. A decade later that bet is paying. Science came first, two dozen projects with NASA, from minerals on the Moon to landing sites on Mars. In 2019 he turned to healthcare, where next generation sequencing convinced him that medicine could be programmed. Using AI to support patients and customers, he has landed two billion dollars of business.

Twenty five years ago he lost his mother to cancer. She asked him to help. He sits on the board of the Lustgarten Foundation, which funds pancreatic cancer research and backed early work on KRAS, a target called undruggable for forty years. In August 2026 the first drug to hit that target was approved for pancreatic cancer. It nearly doubles survival.

The missing piece now is a model that understands change over time. So he works in digital video, where YouTube gives him the data to build it faster. Then he brings it back to cancer.

Short version

120 WORDS

For a panel listing, a slide, or anywhere with a tight word count.

Scott Penberthy was Lou Gerstner's technical assistant at IBM when he built its first web browser and web server in 1992. Four people became two hundred, and two businesses earning four and thirteen billion dollars a year. He ran engineering at Photobucket at fifty million users, then moved PwC to the cloud. He joined Google Cloud in 2016 and started its first applied AI team, first with NASA, then in healthcare, where he has landed two billion dollars of business. Twenty five years ago his mother asked him to help with her cancer. He sits on the board of the Lustgarten Foundation, which backed early KRAS research when that target was still called undruggable. He is still working on it.

Spoken introduction

ABOUT 70 SECONDS

Written to be read aloud from a stage. The surname is said Pen-ber-thee. It ends on the handover, so whoever is introducing him knows where to stop.

Our speaker went to MIT at sixteen. In the early nineties he was Lou Gerstner’s technical assistant at IBM, and he built the company’s first web browser and first web server before most people had heard of the web. Four people became two hundred. That became two businesses earning four billion and thirteen billion dollars a year.

He ran engineering at Photobucket. Fifty million users, a hundred thousand more every day, on machines they ran themselves. He moved PwC to the cloud across a hundred and sixty countries. He joined Google Cloud in 2016, when it was doing less than half a billion dollars a year, and started its first applied AI team. Two dozen projects with NASA, then healthcare, where he has landed two billion dollars of business.

Twenty five years ago he lost his mother to cancer. She asked him to help. He sits on the board of the Lustgarten Foundation, which backed early KRAS research when that target was still called undruggable. He is still working on it. Please welcome Scott Penberthy.

The details programmes ask for

NAME	Scott Penberthy
HOW TO SAY IT	Penberthy is said Pen-ber-thee
HOW TO INTRODUCE HIM	Scott, or Dr. Penberthy in writing
SPEAKING EXPERIENCE	More than 300 keynotes
BOARDS	Lustgarten Foundation for pancreatic cancer research, Stanford cancer tumour board advisory, and a pharmacogenomics board
SITE	scott.ai
THE THESIS	The Approximation Era, which most talks build on
SPEAKING	scott.ai/speaking
EVERYTHING AS A PDF	scott.ai/bio/scott-penberthy-bio.pdf

Photographs, and the latest version of all of this, at scott.ai/bio

Three portraits are there to download, on light and dark grounds and one on stage, free to use with no credit needed. If this sheet has been sitting in a folder for a while, the page is the one that is current.

Views are his own and do not represent his employer or any advisory board he serves on.